# Rotorcraft and Glider Sound for Flight Simulators from First Principles

## A trimmed elastic-blade aeroacoustic model with turbine engines, cabin paths and a glider's airframe, synthesised into seamless loops and checked against closed forms, NASA's and the DNW's rotor tests, published levels and cockpit recordings

Technical report • November 2026

**Abstract**

PyWopWop computes the sound of rotorcraft and gliders for flight simulators from what makes it, and writes it as seamless loops with a FlightGear sound configuration. From a rotor's published geometry it trims the aircraft, solves the elastic blades' loads under a prescribed tip-vortex wake, evaluates Farassat's Formulation 1A of the Ffowcs Williams–Hawkings equation with reception times in closed form, adds BPM self-noise and Amiet's inflow noise per blade segment and azimuth, and carries the result through the air, the ground and, inside, a cabin's walls and modes. Turbine engines follow from their cycle by the methods of NASA's ROTONET, a tiltrotor's wing from Sears' function and statistical energy analysis, and a glider's airframe from its sections' boundary layers. The solvers reproduce the output of NASA's BPM code within 0.012 dB, Gutin's harmonics within 0.08 dB and an independent Formulation 1 within 0.09 %. With nothing fitted to it, the full-scale XV-15 rotor's overall level on NASA's test stand is reproduced from 200 to 10 500 lb of thrust within 2.6 dB (rms) 2 ft from its tip path, including the dip near 2000 lb where the twisted blade's tip unloads, and within 2.2 dB at 76 m; the steady torsion moment of the full-scale Bo 105 blade within 12 %; the shape of the wall pressure measured in flight on the Tu-144LL within 0.7 dB; and the MV-22's published levels in a hover within 3.2 dB. One constant, the tip vortex's effective core, is calibrated on the noise map of the HART II rotor: its baseline case then has a mean error of +0.6 dB and a scatter of 5.0 dB over the microphones' plane, with both of its lobes. In a recording made behind the pilots of an MV-22B in cruise, whose camera's gain and response are unknown, the model at equal loudness is within 2.4 dB in every octave-wide band from 50 Hz to 12 kHz, though several of its parameters were measured from that recording. Building this programme of tests found a dimensional error in the blades' pitching moment, a missing propeller moment, a trim that failed in silence, a calibration aimed at the wrong quantity and a published check of a cabin's doors that turned out to be a measuring artefact; all are corrected or withdrawn here, and are listed. Deficiencies are quantified: the UH-60A's rotors' power at high speed is −25 % from its flight test; the Bo 105's collective stands 2.9–4.2° under NASA's; the one calibrated cockpit level available, the Army's 106 dBA in a UH-60A, stands 3–6 dB over the model's; and the cabins' trim, absorption and the tiltrotor's paths remain estimates fitted to a single flight.

# 1 Introduction

A flight simulator's rotor sound is usually a handful of recordings looped and cross-faded. A recording can only be of what somebody recorded, and what it can't give is what a simulator most needs: the sound of the state the aircraft is actually in. Blade slap comes and goes with a few hundred feet per minute of descent, a tiltrotor sounds different with its nacelles at each angle, a start that hangs should sound hung. The established rotor noise codes compute such things, but not for this purpose. PSU-WOPWOP and its relatives solve the Ffowcs Williams–Hawkings equation for blade loads that come from another program, leave broadband noise to a third, and give pressure histories and spectra. NASA's auralisation framework does turn such predictions into sound, modulated broadband included, but is not public, and its tonal synthesis stops near 2.5 kHz, below the content of blade slap.

PyWopWop was written to close that gap for the FlightGear UH-60A, Bo 105, MV-22B and ASK 21 flight models of this series [1, 2, 3, 4]: one program, a rotor's published geometry in, seamless and alias-free loops out, at the fidelity of those flight models, whose elastic blades, section tables and transcribed test data it shares. Its first loops passed every physics check and were described by their first listener as "a square wave generator, or a lazy machine gun". So the work has had two yardsticks from the start: the physics, against closed forms and tests, and the sound, against recordings.

This report describes the model and how well it does on both. It is the first time the whole has been put through one scripted programme against primary sources, and that programme did what such programmes are for: Section 6 lists what it found wrong. All result tables, figures and the numbers quoted from them are written by the evaluation scripts.

# 2 Reference data

Table 1 lists the sources against which the model is compared; those it is built from are cited in Section 3. Several points of data reduction matter. *(i)* HART II's load and noise figures [13] are digitised: the measured $M^2 c_n$ at $r/R = 0.87$ as the curve's centre line, which a thick plotted line smooths, and the 6–40 blade-passing-frequency (BPF) noise map from its colours (2 dB bands, two of which share a colour) at the microphones' spacing. *(ii)* That map's axis is labelled $-x$ and its top is upstream. The orientation comes from the paper's words, not from any fit: from the baseline the minimum noise case's advancing lobe "was moved forward", which is towards the top of the map, and the minimum vibration case's "was moved back". Read the other way the map correlates with the model at about 0.25; read this way, 0.7. *(iii)* The paper gives its shaft angle, 5.3° aft, without an open jet's correction, so both 5.3° and 4.5° are run. The blades' mass, Lock number and elastic axis are not given: they are the Bo 105's and the quarter chord. *(iv)* CR-177436's near-field microphone stands for a point on a tiltrotor's fuselage in airplane mode: 2 ft outboard of the tip path and 8 ft under the disc. Its far-field microphone is 250 ft out, 15° below the disc plane, and the report does

**Table 1:** Sources and what they contribute.

| Source | Content used |
|---|---|
| NASA RP-1218 [5] | BPM self-noise: the code, ported, and its output tables D2 and D3 |
| NASA TM-86833 [6] | full-scale XV-15 rotor in hover: power against thrust |
| NASA CR-177436 [7] | the same rotor's noise on NASA's outdoor stand, near and far field, against thrust |
| NASA TM-85892, TM-103867, TM-110356 [8, 9, 10] | full-scale Bo 105 rotor: hover and forward-flight power, collective, steady torsion moment |
| USAAEFA 77-17, 83-24 [11, 12] | UH-60A hover and level-flight power |
| Lim et al. [13] | the HART II rotor, its trim, measured airloads, blade motion and noise map |
| Rutledge et al. [14]; George [15]; NASA SP-2000-4517 [16] | XV-15 hovering over ground boards, the fountain's turbulence, the fences' effect, the noise behind the aircraft |
| Japan's Ministry of Defense [17] | MV-22 outside levels, airplane mode and hover |
| National Academies [20] | UH-60A cockpit level from the US Army |
| NASA TM-105805 [18] | T700 steady states from GE's simulation |
| NASA CR-2005-213938 [46] | wall pressure spectra in flight, Tu-144LL |
| Video recordings | UH-60 starts and flight, MV-22B in cruise, ASK 21 aerobatics (Section 2) |

not say what the ground did to it; the model is run in free air. The figures are "typical" faired curves, traced from the scan. *(v)* The published MV-22 table [17] gives maximum levels without saying the hover's height, the listener's direction or the meter's response, nor the ground. The airplane-mode levels are directly below at 220 kt. *(vi)* USAAEFA's power is both engines' output on the main rotor's disc; the model's is both rotors', without the transmission and accessories, which take a few per cent. *(vii)* All the recordings come from public videos: camera microphones with automatic gain and an unknown response, some with music. Absolute levels cannot be read from them. Only ratios within a moment are used: tones over the broadband beside them, the sound's pulsing, spectral shapes at equal loudness (ITU-R BS.1770 [19], never A-weighting, which is blind to the lows a listener hears), and how these change. Airspeed, load factor and sideslip in the gliders' videos were read off the instruments in the picture.

# 3 The model

## 3.1 Aircraft, trim and inflow

An aircraft is a list of rotors with published data: radius, blades, chord, twist, section, speed. The tip-path planes lie normal to the force balancing weight, download and an equivalent flat plate's drag; the tail rotor carries the main rotor's torque. Each rotor is then trimmed to its thrust with no first-harmonic flapping relative to its tip-path plane by a Newton iteration on collective and cyclic, the elastic response converged with it. The sections are lift, drag and moment tables against angle of attack and Mach number from the flight models [21, 22], resampled by monotone cubics so that the loads have no kinks to ring in the loading noise; the blade surface comes from the section's coordinates. Inflow is blade-element momentum theory with Prandtl's tip loss in the hover, Glauert's momentum and Drees' first harmonics [23] in forward flight, an empirical bridge through the vortex ring state, and Cheeseman and Bennett's factor [24] in ground effect.

## 3.2 Elastic blades

Any rotor's blade is a rotating Euler–Bernoulli beam: a Galerkin solution for its flap modes, hinged or clamped, its bending stiffness set so that the mode the data name has its published frequency, so that a hingeless blade cones by bending in its first mode. One torsion mode has a shape between a fixed-free bar and rigid pitch on the control system. Flap and torsion are coupled by the section's centre of mass aft of the elastic axis, by a distance $d$, through its inertia and through the centrifugal force on a sloped blade,

$$M_\theta(r) = q\,c^2\left[c_m + c_l(x_{ea} - \tfrac{1}{4})\right] + m\,d\,\Omega^2 r\,w' - i_\theta\,\Omega^2 \sin\theta\cos\theta, \quad (1)$$

the last term the propeller moment on the pitch the controls and the built-in twist set. The periodic response is found by harmonic balance within the trim, the linearised aerodynamics moved to the left-hand side as an approximate Jacobian. Deflections enter the angle of attack through flap velocity, slope and elastic twist, and the wake through the blade's height, which sets the blade–vortex miss distance.

## 3.3 Blade–vortex interaction

The tip vortex is prescribed after Beddoes [25]: released at the deflected tip with a share (the roll-up, 0.7) of the peak bound circulation, carried by the free stream, sinking with $\lambda_0(1 + Ex - E|y|^3)$ under the disc and $2\lambda_0(1 - E|y|^3)$ downstream of it, $E = \chi/2$ with the wake skew $\chi$. Its velocities are Biot–Savart's with a Vatistas $n = 2$ core [26], $v_\theta = \Gamma h/2\pi\sqrt{r_c^4 + h^4}$, growing with age by Squire's law [27]. They are sampled over the chord with thin-airfoil weights, a lifting chord rather than a lifting line. Only the impulsive part is kept, the difference from the same wake with a core 1.5 chords wider; the smooth part is the inflow model's. It builds up on the blade through Wagner's response, $1 - 0.165e^{-0.0455s} - 0.335e^{-0.3s}$, scaled for compressibility. The core is an effective one (Section 5.5).

Real rotors are not periodic. Eight revolutions are computed, each with its own turbulent gusts from a frozen von Kármán field and its own vortex wander and strength, and in the loop each blade morphs from one to another, passage by passage, by Dirichlet weights. Without this a loop is a machine gun. The turbulence round the older vortices, met by the following blades, goes through Amiet's inflow noise: the swish and crackle around the slap.

## 3.4 Tonal noise

Thickness comes from the blade's panelled surface and loading from the sections' forces spread over the chord by thin-

airfoil shares, by Farassat's Formulation 1A [28]:

$$4\pi p_L = \Big[\frac{\dot{L}_r}{c\,r\,(1-M_r)^2} + \frac{L_r - L_M}{r^2(1-M_r)^2} + \frac{L_r\,(r\dot{M}_r + c(M_r - M^2))}{c\,r^2(1-M_r)^3}\Big]_{\text{ret}}. \quad (2)$$

For a listener in uniform motion the reception time is closed form: with $\mathbf{d}$ the separation at emission and $\mathbf{v}$ the listener's velocity, $s = [\mathbf{d}\cdot\mathbf{v} + \sqrt{(\mathbf{d}\cdot\mathbf{v})^2 + (c^2 - v^2)d^2}]/(c^2 - v^2)$. So no iteration is needed: the kernel runs in source time, in parallel over elements, kinematics analytic. A steady rotor is periodic and its blades identical, so one blade over one revolution gives the exact Fourier series of them all.

## 3.5 Broadband noise

BPM's trailing-edge, bluntness, tip and laminar-shedding noise [5], ported line for line, and Amiet's inflow noise [29] are evaluated for every blade segment at every azimuth with the retarded geometry of the tonal noise, BPM's directivity and the Doppler shift. Each lands at its reception time, which gives a spectral history over the revolution: the blade-passage modulation that a mean spectrum loses. The air's turbulence fades with height, from the surface layer's to a quarter of it above 1000 m. Near the ground the rotor also meets its own recirculating downwash.

## 3.6 A tiltrotor's wing

*Behind the discs.* In airplane mode each blade's bound vortex, the tip and root vortices it trails and its viscous wake (Lakshminarayana and Davino's deficit [30]) sweep an upwash over the wing's leading edge once a revolution. Each strip answers as a section meeting a convected gust, by Sears' function [31], $F_m = \pi\rho c U a_m S(\sigma_m)\Delta y$ with $S = \exp[-\frac{i\pi}{4}\frac{a}{1+a}]/\sqrt{1+a}$, $a = 2\pi\sigma$, and radiates as a dipole, part of the blade's loading harmonics. Where the tip circle crosses the wing the vortices run into its leading edge 3 ms old, and the harmonics fall slowly. Near the fuselage the same loads reach the cabin through the structure, by statistical energy analysis: the power fed in through an input mobility $Y$, stored against a loss factor $\eta$, radiated by the panels between frames and stringers with Maidanik's edge-mode efficiency $\sigma$ [32],

$$\overline{p^2} = \frac{2(\rho c)^2 \sigma\, Y\, |F|^2}{\omega\,\eta\,m\,A\,\alpha}\ \min(1, f/f_{11})^3. \quad (3)$$

*Under the discs.* In a hover the wing blocks part of each rotor's downwash, which meets the other's over the fuselage and rises back through the discs. The inflow over the wing falls by 20 % across 0.6 of its chord, after Rutledge, Coffen and George's model of the XV-15 [14], a jump in each blade's load that radiates spikes behind the aircraft, of a strength of their own each revolution; the turbulence it brings back, 25 % of the induced velocity over the disc's outer third from the wing rearward and the disc's height over the wing its length scale [15], goes through Amiet's inflow noise. Both are gone with the download by 15 m/s.

## 3.7 Turbine engines

An engine's state follows its gas generator speed along the operating line: the compressor's temperature rise as a power of $N_g$ through its published delivery pressures, the flight model's fuel flow, Stodola's ellipse law through the turbines, calibrated on the published power turbine inlet temperature, the shaft power of the flight model's torque line. Its sources are those of ROTONET [33]: the first two compressor stages by Heidmann's method [34] in Hough and Weir's small-engine revision [35], with buzz-saw tones once the relative tip speed is supersonic; combustion noise through the turbines by GE's method in SAE ARP 876 [36]; the power turbine's last stage [37]; the jet; and an air turbine starter. APUs and gearboxes are given by recorded or published signatures that move with their speed and torque [38]. Every frequency of a turbomachine scales with its shaft speed, so a start or a shutdown is the loops following the flight model's $N_g$.

## 3.8 Cabin paths

A panel's transmission loss is the field-incidence mass law, $20\log_{10}(mf) - 47$ dB, below half its coincidence frequency and Sharp's above it [39]. A trimmed sidewall is a double wall [40]: the mass law of both leaves below the mass-air-mass resonance, then $TL_1 + TL_2 + 20\log_{10}(2kd)$, then $TL_1 + TL_2 + 6$ dB. Areas add by composite transmission, an open door's share passing everything. Inside, sound builds up by $1/\alpha$, where $\alpha$ counts what the interior absorbs and what the walls let back out, from the cabin's lowest mode up; below it the cabin is one pressure chamber.

With a fuselage described, the rotors are heard through the pressure on it rather than at the listener's head. Below the lowest mode the wall patches' pressures average, delayed by their paths; above it their powers add, each harmonic a draw of the cabin's modal response: Schroeder's complex Gaussian [41], a random phase with levels scattered by 5.6 dB, one draw per harmonic. Without this, neighbouring lines of equal level beat far harder than a real cabin's do. Near a blade most of the pressure is its hydrodynamic footprint, the terms of Formulation 1A that fall as $1/r^2$, which sweeps along the skin at the tip's speed and drives it as a boundary layer's eddies do, poorly below its hydrodynamic coincidence; only the radiating terms pass as sound.

## 3.9 Wind

The cockpit's wind is the turbulent boundary layer's wall pressure on the skin, each patch at its run from the nose: Goody's spectral shape [42] at Farabee and Casarella's level [43], $\overline{p^2}/\tau_w^2 = 6.5 + 1.86\ln(Re_\tau/333)$, through the walls as Levine and DeFelice predict a helicopter's cabin noise [44]. A panel couples poorly to the convected eddies below its hydrodynamic coincidence and leaks pass none of them. At altitude a true airspeed $V$ sounds like sea level's at $V_{eq} = V(\nu/\nu_0)^{-1/6}$, louder in amplitude by $\sqrt{\sigma\mu/\mu_0}$, so that one bank of sea-level loops serves any altitude.

## 3.10 Gliders

A glider has no engine; what is heard is the air. Its wing and tail make BPM's noise on the real sections' boundary layers, which NeuralFoil [47] gives at each strip's Reynolds number and angle of attack, the separated share of the chord replacing BPM's angle stages. Under the canopy the fuselage's potential flow (a panel method with the wing's lifting

line) gives each panel of the glass the boundary layer of the streamline that reaches it, and Goody's wall pressure passes the acrylic by the mass law. Airbrakes are Curle dipoles with assumed force coefficients. Steady manoeuvres deflect the sections and balance the moments.

### 3.11 Synthesis and propagation

Tones are synthesised additively from the exact harmonics, as a wavetable synthesiser does: band limited by construction, below the Nyquist frequency over the largest pitch factor the simulator applies, so that pitching a loop with the rotor's speed cannot alias. A loop holds an integer number of revolutions in an integer number of samples, the rotor's speed nudged by under a cent: it is a true period, not a crossfade. Broadband is band noise shaped by the spectral history's blade-passage envelope. ISO 9613 absorption [48], turbulent-air scintillation, the ground's reflection (Delany and Bazley [49]) and a light diffuse field complete the outside. A bank renders every flight condition at four positions and the cockpit in layers that add up to the mix, with a FlightGear section whose volumes, evaluated as SimGear evaluates them, sum to one everywhere.

## 4 Method

The test programme, `report/mkresults.py`, runs the comparisons below from the package as distributed, in stages, into result files; the tables, figures and quoted numbers are generated from those. Recordings are not distributed, but what is measured from them is kept in the results, so the report rebuilds without them. The programme was first run on the state of the code before this report, kept as "before" throughout; that run found the faults of Section 6, and the final results are of the corrected code.

What is compared with what deserves stating, because it decides what a result means. *Predictions* use nothing from the comparison: the solvers' checks, the XV-15 stand, the Bo 105's torsion, the UH-60A's power, the MV-22's table. *Calibrations* set a constant from the data shown: the vortex core on HART II. *Measurements* take a number from the recording and then show it back: Table 2 lists these, and a comparison on them proves only consistency. The XV-15's hover power is a case apart: its section's stall and drag constants were fitted to that test in the V-22 flight model, whose table it now uses.

## 5 Results

### 5.1 Verification

Table 3 and Fig. 1 show that the solvers do what they say. The port's error against table D2 is at the table's print precision; the tip column of table D3 differs by 0.19 dB where the tip lies 70 dB under the total, which a 0.3 % different Strouhal number in the run that made the table explains. The test suite's 80 tests pass.

**Table 2:** What is not simply published.

| | |
|---|---|
| Calibrated | vortex core 0.8 chord (HART II's noise); roll-up 0.7; the MV-22B's section constants (XV-15 hover test) |
| Measured from recordings | T700 blade counts 20 and 22; AE 1107C blade count 32; APU signature; relative gearbox tones; MV-22B: drive's roar and meshes, wall masses, structure's mobility, rotor index 26.4°, modal draw, load ripple, 18 dB forward path loss |
| Assumed | blade-wake turbulence 0.2; gusts 1 m/s; wander 0.25 chord; airbrake force coefficients; recirculation 20 % of $v_h$ |
| Estimated | vane counts, stage geometry, starter; cabin skins and absorption |

**Table 3:** The solvers against closed forms and NASA's code.

| Check | Against | Error |
|---|---|---|
| BPM self-noise, untripped section | NASA RP-1218 table D2 | 0.006 dB |
| BPM, tripped, ten segments | table D3 (tip column 0.19 dB) | 0.012 dB |
| F1A loading, hover harmonics | Gutin's closed form | 0.08 dB |
| F1A, hover, unsteady loads and heave | Formulation 1, numerical derivative | 0.014 % |
| F1A, a fly-by past a fixed listener | the same | 0.09 % |
| Reception time, closed form | the retarded-time equation | round-off |
| Absorption | ISO 9613-2 table 2, as printed | none |
| Bo 105 second flap frequency from the first | published 2.78/rev | 2.83/rev |
| Loops: above the band limit | none | −315 dB |

### 5.2 Rotor aerodynamics

Fig. 2 compares power. The XV-15 rotor is within −5 to +2 % of its test over its whole range, as it should be with a section fitted to it. The Bo 105's is +1 to −17 % from the test in the hover, falling short at high thrust; in the tunnel, shaft forward, +3 % below $\mu = 0.2$ and −6 % above 0.27. The UH-60A's rotors are −12 to −9 % from the engines' output in the hover, and in level flight −18 % up to $\mu = 0.24$ at $C_T = 0.0065$ and −25 % above $\mu = 0.28$. A few per cent of that is the transmission and accessories. The rest is not the rotor model at large, since the Bo 105 shows nothing like it at the same advance ratios; it may lie in the UH-60A's advancing tip, deep in the drag rise, or in its airframe's balance. It is not resolved. For the sound it matters less than it seems: the thrust is held and the loading noise follows the thrust, though the torque's share is low by as much.

### 5.3 The elastic blade

Fig. 3 is the test that found the program's worst fault. The Bo 105's steady torsion moment at $0.34\,R$ is within 12 % of NASA's measurement at every thrust, nothing fitted, its three parts (the aerodynamic moment, the centrifugal force on the offset centre of mass, and the propeller moment) being each several times the difference between them. The blade twists −1.4° at the tip at $C_T/\sigma = 0.12$, where it twisted +3.3° before (Section 6). On HART II's rotor the mean tip twist is −1.1°, the measured about −1° [13]; its flap at the tip runs from −0.025 to −0.020 m against a measured −0.03 to +0.01, the model missing the measurement's 2/rev. The collective stands 2.9–4.2° under the test's, where it stood 4.1–8.5°; the flight model built on the blade's real distributions finds 2.5–3.1° [2], and the remainder here grows with thrust.

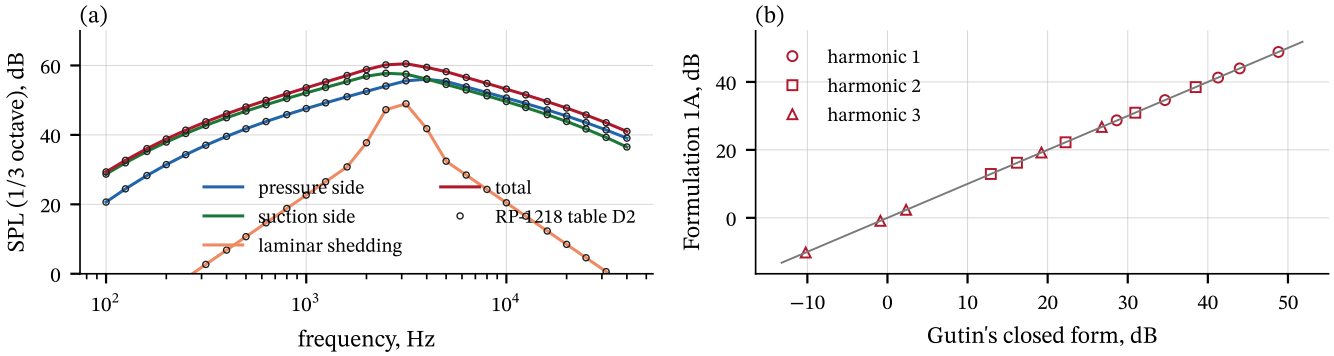



**Figure 1:** (a) The BPM port against the output of NASA's code; (b) Formulation 1A against Gutin's hover harmonics at five polar angles.

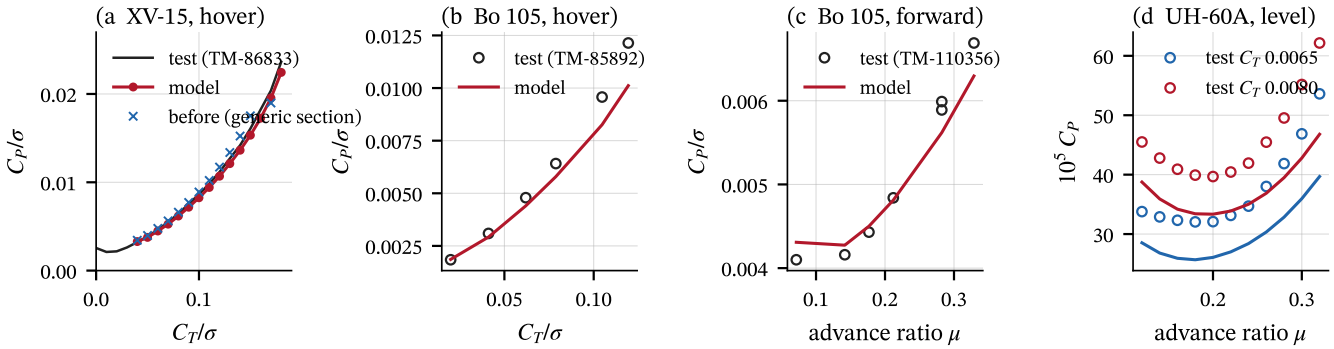



**Figure 2:** Rotor power against tests: (a) the XV-15 rotor in hover, with what the trim returned for the generic section past its stall; (b, c) the Bo 105 rotor on NASA's stand and in its tunnel, $C_T/\sigma = 0.07$, shaft 10° forward; (d) the UH-60A in level flight, both engines' output against both rotors' power.

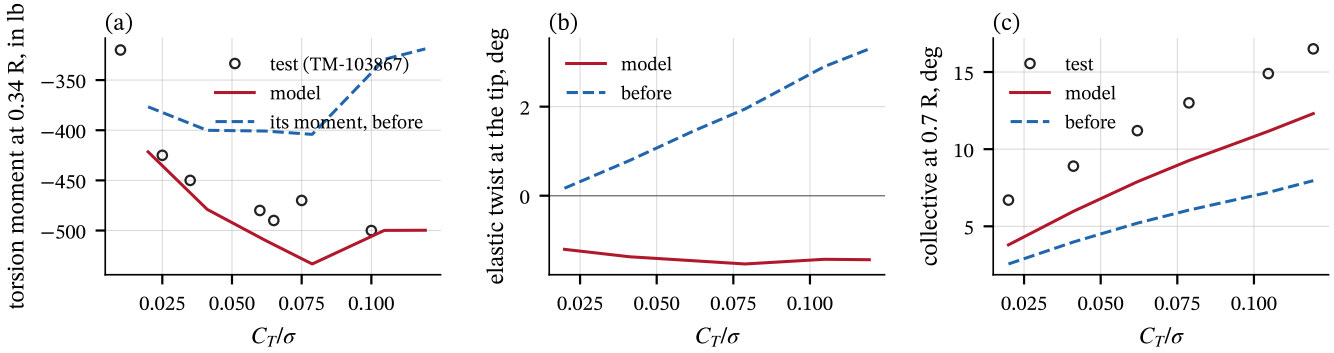



**Figure 3:** The Bo 105's blade in hover, before and after the correction of its pitching moment: (a) the steady torsion moment at 0.34 $R$ against NASA's; (b) the elastic twist at the tip; (c) collective at 0.7 $R$.

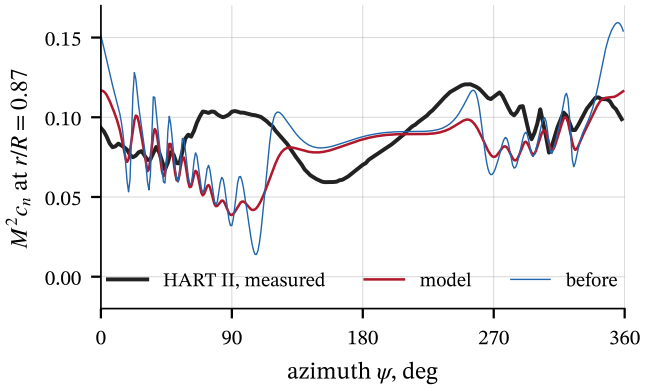



**Figure 4:** HART II baseline: section normal force at $r/R = 0.87$.

## 5.4 Absolute level: the XV-15 rotor on NASA's stand

This is the program's first absolute test of a rotor's level, and it uses no calibration at all: no wake passes close to a hovering blade. Fig. 5 gives the result. In the near field the model is −2.1 dB from the test on average, 2.6 dB rms, and at most 3.9 dB, from 200 to 10 500 lb. It finds the dip: 111.3 dB at 2500 lb against the test's 111.8 dB at 2000 lb. The blade's 36° of twist is why there is one. At low thrust its outer fifth carries negative lift, which only passes zero near 2753 lb, and a microphone 2 ft from the tip hears the tip first: the loading noise falls into a null as the tip unloads, adding to the thickness noise below it and cancelling it above, until the broadband is left. That near field is the one the MV-22B's cabin path rests on: the microphone was placed to stand for a tiltrotor's fuselage. In the far field the model is −2.1 dB from the test, 2.2 dB rms, the shape right; a microphone near the ground would read up to 6 dB over the free field, so the offset may

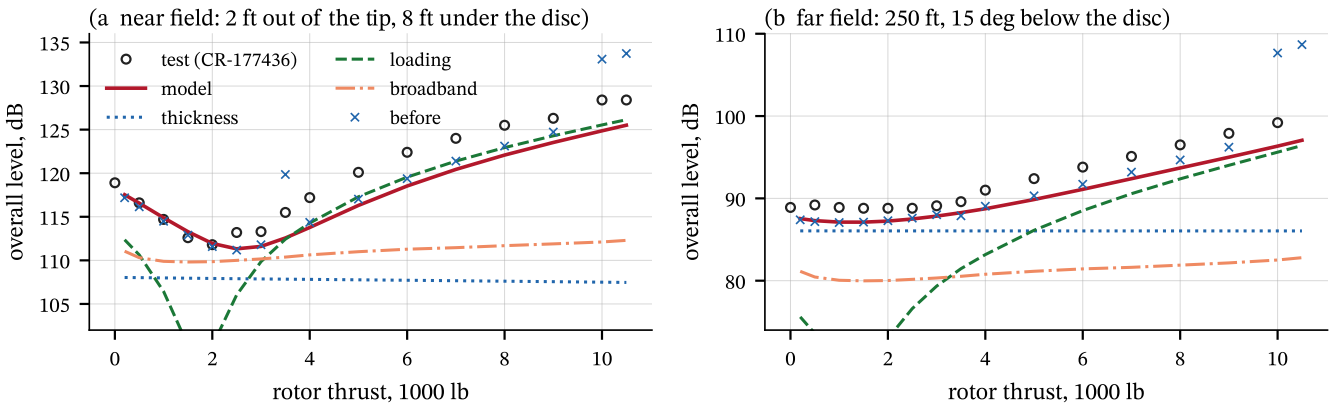



**Figure 5:** The full-scale XV-15 rotor's overall level against thrust on NASA's outdoor stand, tip Mach number 0.69, nothing fitted. Near field: the dip is where the tip's negative lift gives way, and the loading noise a microphone so close to the tip hears passes through a null.

**Table 4:** HART II baseline: the core's calibration. $\alpha_s$ in degrees, core in tip chords, rms of the load above 10/rev, the lobes' peaks, the map's mean error and scatter (dB) and its correlation with the measurement.

| $\alpha_s$ | core | roll | $\overline{M^2 c_n}$ | rms | adv. | ret. | mean | rms | $r$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5.3 | 0.80 | 0.7 | 0.081 | 0.0047 | 113.9 | 108.1 | +0.6 | 5.0 | 0.69 |
| 4.5 | 0.80 | 0.7 | 0.082 | 0.0050 | 115.1 | 109.9 | +2.5 | 5.0 | 0.70 |
| 5.3 | 0.12 | 1.0 | 0.090 | 0.0264 | 126.3 | 119.4 | +11.5 | 5.3 | 0.67 |
| 5.3 | 0.40 | 0.7 | 0.084 | 0.0112 | 119.9 | 113.4 | +5.7 | 5.1 | 0.68 |
| 5.3 | 0.60 | 0.7 | 0.082 | 0.0072 | 117.2 | 111.1 | +3.6 | 5.1 | 0.68 |
| 5.3 | 0.70 | 0.7 | 0.082 | 0.0058 | 115.6 | 109.7 | +2.2 | 5.1 | 0.68 |
| 5.3 | 0.90 | 0.7 | 0.081 | 0.0038 | 112.1 | 106.5 | −1.2 | 5.0 | 0.70 |
| 5.3 | 1.00 | 0.7 | 0.080 | 0.0031 | 110.2 | 104.7 | −3.1 | 4.9 | 0.71 |
| 5.3 | 1.20 | 0.7 | 0.080 | 0.0020 | 106.1 | 100.9 | −7.3 | 4.8 | 0.72 |
| measured | | | 0.092 | 0.0030 | 114 | 112 | | | |

**Table 5:** Loops against recordings: how alike consecutive blade passages are, the harmonics against the noise from 100 Hz to 3 kHz, and the crest factor. In brackets, the same render without the unsteadiness.

| Sound | corr. | tones, dB | crest, dB |
|---|---|---|---|
| UH-60, outside, flat pitch | 0.46 | −8 | 13 |
| UH-60, outside, blade slap | 0.45 | −9 | 10 |
| UH-60, blade slap | 0.58 | −6 | 8 |
| Bo 105, rotor | 0.31 | −11 | 13 |
| Bo 105, blade slap | 0.17 | −11 | 14 |
| UH-60A hover (steady: 0.72) | 0.14 | −8 | 15 |
| UH-60A cruise (steady: 0.76) | 0.32 | −7 | 13 |
| UH-60A approach (steady: 0.97) | 0.57 | +0 | 17 |
| Bo 105 cruise (steady: 0.46) | 0.25 | −9 | 11 |
| Bo 105 approach (steady: 0.96) | 0.63 | −3 | 17 |

not be the model's. Before the XV-15 had its real section the same comparison gave 133.1 and 107.7 dB at 10 000 lb, against 128.4 and 99.2: a trim failed in silence (Section 6).

## 5.5 Blade–vortex interaction: HART II

HART II [13] is the one rotor whose blade loads, deflections, wake and noise were all measured at one condition, at the maximum of its blade–vortex noise. With the rotor's published data the model gives a mean $M^2 c_n$ of 0.081 against 0.092 (Fig. 4). Its impulsive part is another matter. A lifting line with the measured core, 0.12 chord, and all the circulation is 8.8 times too strong in the load above 10/rev and +11.5 dB too loud over the plane. The real vortex is displaced and spread by the approaching blade, which a prescribed wake doesn't do: hence an effective core. It had been set at 0.4 chord to bring the UH-60A's and UH-1H's swings to "about 0.1 in $M^2 c_n$", a figure taken for HART II's swing that is in fact its mean: the swing is near 0.0030 rms. That left the program 3.7 times too strong in the load and +5.5 dB too loud (Table 4).

Calibrated on the noise itself, the core is 0.8 chord. Fig. 6 shows the result. The mean error over the plane is +0.6 dB by construction; what the calibration does not give is the rest. The scatter is 5.0 dB and the correlation 0.69, nearly the same at every core. Both lobes are there: the advancing one at 113.9 dB against 114, a metre downstream of the measured one, and the retreating one in its place but 4 dB weak, 108.1 against 112. The whole of this is the wake: without its impulses the plane's peak is 74 dB, 40 dB down. The load's rms is still 1.6 times the digitised measurement's, of which the thick line and the 2° reading take something. The prediction teams' own maps in the same paper, with free wakes and full comprehensive analyses, differ from the measurement by several decibels and from each other by as much [13], so this is about what the state of the art gives, at a small part of its cost, for a calibrated constant. Johnson's free-wake model of the V-22's scaled rotor uses a core of 20 % of the mean chord [50]; the larger value here is the price of the prescribed wake.

The rest of the wake's behaviour needs no calibration: where the slap comes and goes. HART II's baseline was set where the shaft-angle sweep found the maximum noise, 5.3°; the model's maximum is at 4.0° (Fig. 7a). In full-scale descents the slap peaks at 800 ft/min for the UH-60A at 65 kt and 800 ft/min for the UH-1H at 70 kt, with the wake in the disc's plane, and falls away in steeper descents as the wake rises through the disc (Fig. 7b).

## 5.6 Texture

A loop can have the right spectrum and sound like nothing that flies. Table 5 shows the measures that told the first loops from recordings. Consecutive blade passages in the recordings correlate at 0.17–0.58, in a perfectly periodic render up to 0.97, and with the unsteadiness at 0.14–0.63. An approach

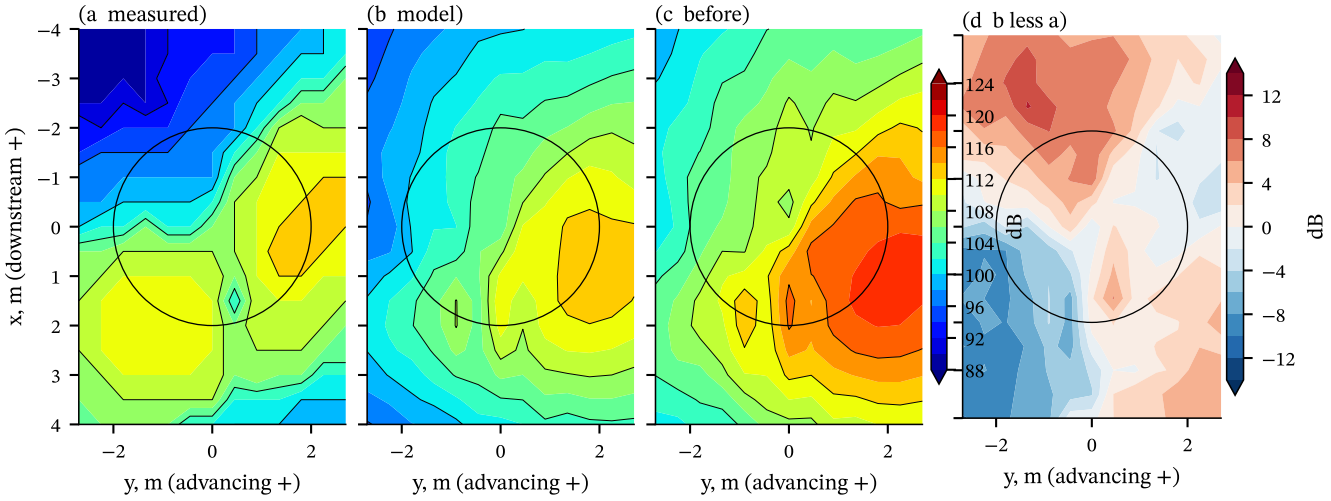



**Figure 6:** HART II baseline, 6–40 BPF level on the plane 2.215 m under the hub: (a) measured [13], (b) the model, (c) the model before, (d) the model less the measurement. Flow from top to bottom is upstream to downstream; the circle is the disc.

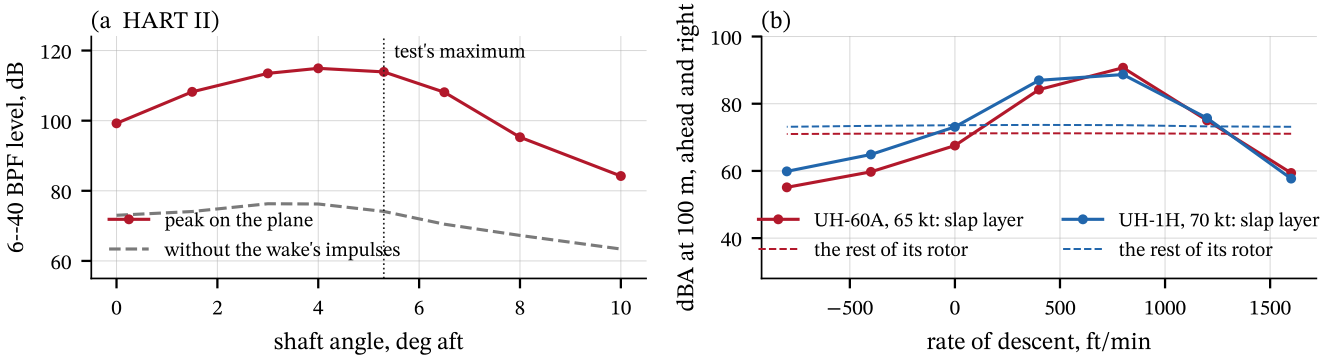



**Figure 7:** (a) HART II's noise against shaft angle: the test's baseline is at its maximum. (b) Slap against the rate of descent.

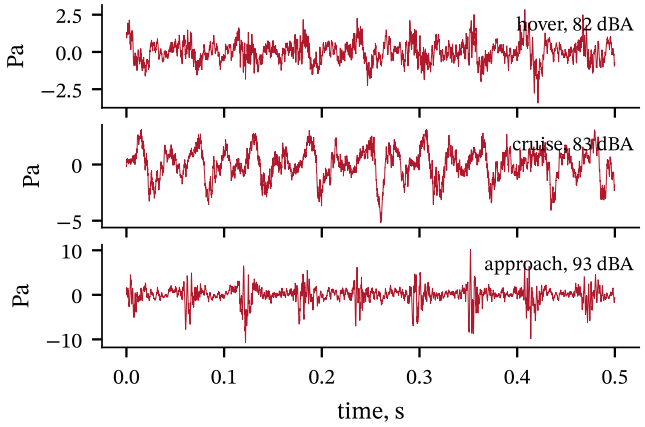



**Figure 8:** UH-60A loops at 100 m: half a second of a hover, a cruise and an approach.

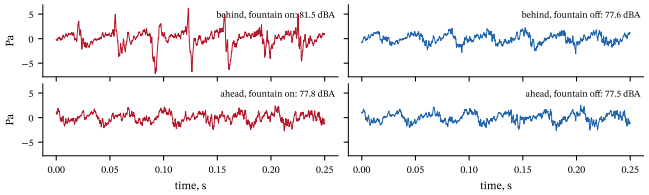



**Figure 9:** XV-15 hovering over a ground board at 57 radii, 46° below the disc.

**Table 6:** MV-22 in a hover: published maxima and the model's rotors, fast response, hard ground, dBA.

| m | table | behind | side | no fountain | hub 30 m |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 50 | 105.3 | 104.5 | 102.1 | 101.6 | 104.5 |
| 100 | 100.4 | 98.2 | 95.7 | 95.6 | 95.7 |
| 200 | 95.5 | 92.3 | 89.5 | 89.6 | 85.3 |
| 500 | 84.5 | 84.0 | 81.4 | 81.5 | 74.1 |

is +5 dBA over a cruise for the same listener (Fig. 8), where it was +25 in the first loops and +11 with the previous core.

## 5.7 Tiltrotors outside

A hovering tiltrotor is louder behind than to the side, which surprised NASA in 1981 and which George explained by the fountain's reingestion [16]. The model has the same asymmetry from the same cause (Fig. 9). At 57 radii on a ground board the wave ahead is about 2 Pa, as measured [14], with no spikes; behind, spikes reach 11 Pa at 46° below the disc, measured about 15, and 8–10 Pa at 13° and 23°, measured 5: too strong by up to a factor of two near the disc's plane and too weak well below it. The fountain adds 4.3 dBA behind and 0.2 ahead; fences that removed it took 4.1 dBA off [15].

Table 6 and Fig. 10 set the MV-22's rotors against the published maxima [17]. Behind the aircraft, 30° below the disc, over hard ground at fast response, they are within 3.2 dB, nothing fitted; the fountain gives 2.7 dB of that. Since the table doesn't say where its microphones were, this shows that a reasonable geometry reproduces it, no more; a low hover heard along the ground falls away too fast to fit. In airplane mode

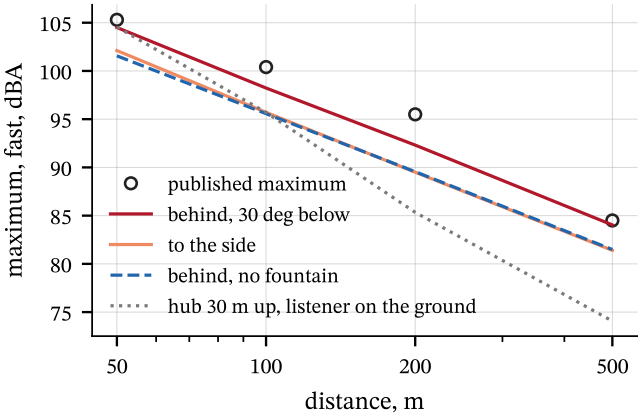



**Figure 10:** MV-22 hover levels against distance.

at 220 kt directly below, the model makes 90.5 dBA at 100 m, which spreading alone takes to 86.9, 80.9 and 77.3 dBA at 500, 1000 and 1500 ft against 88, 81 and 78; without the wing it made 78.

## 5.8 Turbine engines

The T700's cycle follows GE's simulation within 1.5 % in delivery pressure and 72 K in power turbine inlet temperature, hot where GenHel's fuel flow, which the flight model uses, runs about 5 % over GE's (Fig. 11). The AE 1107C's published design point is met by construction: 15.9 kg/s and 1208 °C against 15.9 and 1209.

Tones are where recordings are at their best, since frequency survives any camera. A UH-60M's whine at idle settles on two lines at 10.06 and 11.07 kHz, in the ratio 1.100: exactly 10:11, which gives its first two stages 20 and 22 blades at 67.5 % $N_g$. The same whine sits at 12.91 kHz on the ground at FLY and 14.04 kHz in the hover (86.7 and 94.3 %). The gearbox's planetary mesh stands at 993 Hz, its line growing 22 dB over the floor beside it from flat pitch to the hover, where its amplitude's following the torque gives 12 dB: the mesh depends on its load more steeply than that, or at flat pitch it isn't heard at all, which a line 3 dB over its floor can't tell.

Outside, 50 m to the right, one T700 makes 69 dBA at idle, 84 at 87.5 % and 89 at full power, and the APU 84, against 85 dBA contours past 100 ft and levels of 105 dB or more measured round a whole UH-60 on the ground [51]. GE's and Heidmann's methods are empirical and good to about 5 dB.

## 5.9 Cabins and wind

Fig. 13 shows the walls: the MV-22B's double wall far tighter than one wall above its resonance at 136 Hz, and the windows' coincidence dips. Opening every door and window of the UH-60A adds 22 dB to the path at 10 kHz, a figure with no measurement behind it now (Section 6). One calibrated level exists: the US Army's 106 dBA at the pilot's and copilot's seats of a UH-60A in flight, the condition not stated [20]. The model gives 102.6 dBA in the hover and 99.7 at 120 kt, 3–6 dB under it: the gearbox 102 dBA in the hover, whose level comes from NASA's review [38], so that this is a check of consistency, the rotors 83 to 91 and the engines 77. The wall pressure lies at 0.0080–0.0095 $q$ over the flight range, against Bies's compilation of flight and tunnel data, about 0.0066 $q$ [45]. In flight the Tu-144LL measured

**Table 7:** MV-22B cockpit: recording and model.

| Measure | recording | model |
|---|---|---|
| whine, 7.08 kHz, over its neighbours, dB | 0.3 | 0.8 |
| mesh, 2.03 kHz, over its neighbours, dB | 5.4 | 5.6 |
| mesh, 8.17 kHz, over its neighbours, dB | 4.7 | 5.4 |
| 50–100 Hz: blade lines' share, % | 83 | 90 |
| 100–200 Hz: blade lines' share, % | 69 | 68 |
| 200–300 Hz: blade lines' share, % | 20 | 26 |
| 300–400 Hz: blade lines' share, % | 21 | 16 |
| 50–100 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 8.1 | 3.6 |
| 100–200 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 4.9 | 4.5 |
| 200–300 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 1.6 | 3.2 |
| 300–400 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 3.0 | 2.2 |
| 500–1000 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 1.2 | 1.4 |
| 1000–2000 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 1.3 | 1.0 |
| 2000–5000 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 1.0 | 0.8 |
| 5000–12000 Hz: pulsing per pass, dB | 1.2 | 0.9 |
| harmonics 2–5 over the floor, dB | 21.7 | 18.0 |
| harmonics 6–13 over the floor, dB | 13.0 | 15.7 |
| harmonics 14–30 over the floor, dB | 5.6 | 4.4 |

**Table 8:** Each term of the proprotors' path taken out: their level, harmonics over the floor (dB), the 100–200 Hz band's pulsing (dB) and line share (%).

| Case | dBA | h2–5 | h6–13 | h14–30 | pulse | share |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| the model | 93.4 | 18.0 | 15.7 | 4.4 | 3.9 | 59 |
| no wing source | 79.9 | 16.2 | 7.2 | −0.1 | 2.1 | 24 |
| rotors in step | 92.9 | 26.0 | 13.9 | 4.7 | 5.1 | 59 |
| sea-level air | 97.0 | 6.8 | 16.8 | 6.3 | 4.1 | 61 |
| single wall, no trim | 95.0 | 19.4 | 16.8 | 5.1 | 4.1 | 61 |
| recording | | 21.7 | 13.0 | 5.6 | 4.9 | 69 |

it in absolute terms [46]: at Mach 0.74 and 16 400 ft, midfuselage, the model's spectrum keeps the measured shape within 0.7 dB rms from 100 Hz to 10 kHz, closer than the five established models that report tried, and is −2.4 dB in level (Fig. 12), at 0.0065 $q$. That run's Reynolds number, $3 \times 10^8$, is far past what the 1/7-power skin friction used until then can reach, which stood 4.8 dB under; White's law takes half of that. The rest isn't explained, the sensors themselves scattering by about 1.5 dB and the model leaving out compressibility. The wind's altitude scaling holds the spectrum from 125 Hz to 2 kHz within 0.2 dB to 12 km and 0.7 dB at 21 km, and is 4.0 dB out at 16 kHz there.

## 5.10 The MV-22B's cockpit

A public video of an MV-22B in airplane-mode cruise has a camera behind the pilots for two and a half minutes and at a cabin window beside a nacelle for as long. The proprotors pass their blades at 16.62 Hz (332 rpm, the preset's airplane mode). At the window the first compressor stage's whine stands at 7.08 kHz and falls to 6.73 kHz as the power comes off; 32 blades put it there at the flight model's 90.5 % $n_1$. It is chopped by the proprotor, its line's envelope 28 dB over its floor at the blade rate where the broadband beside it shows 17: the model doesn't have this.

This comparison took the most work, and the least of it is prediction. Heard at the listener's head through limp walls the model was the proprotors' first harmonics with little else,

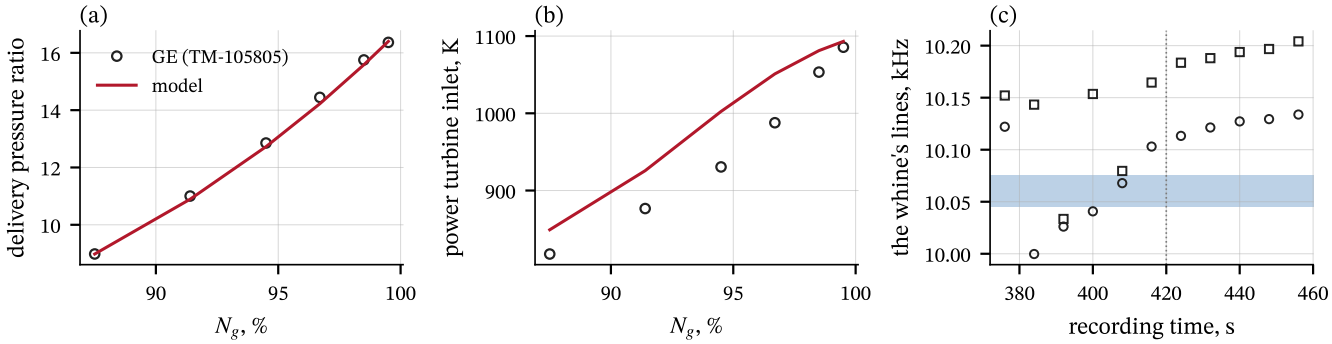



**Figure 11:** (a, b) The T700's cycle against GE's simulation. (c) The two whine lines in a UH-60's recording, drifting up through the ±15 Hz window (shaded) in which an earlier check read them, at the moment (dotted) it took for the doors closing.

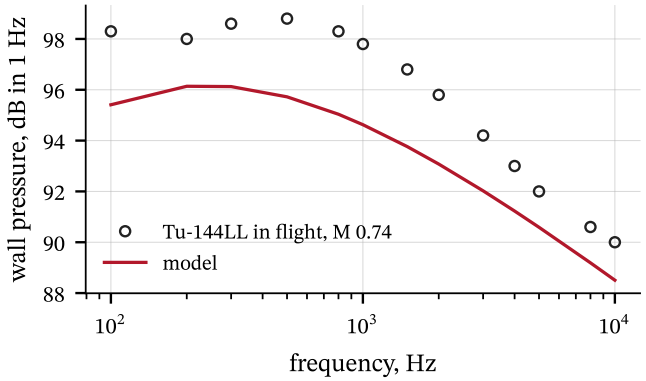



**Figure 12:** The boundary layer's wall pressure in flight [46].

"a wind tunnel" to the ear that compared them. What the recording has besides is a steady roar from 40 Hz to 12 kHz, strongest by the wing's root: the drive's and engines' vibration through the wing and the frames, which cannot be computed and is measured. The proprotors' harmonics from the 6th to the 30th stand far out of that roar, 0.75 dB a harmonic down, where a blade's own pressure falls 2.4; the wing behind the discs makes them, and through the structure its loads fall 0.9 dB a harmonic as the recording's do. What remains after these terms is in Table 7 and Fig. 14: at equal loudness the model is within 2.4 dB in every octave-wide band from 50 Hz to 12 kHz (9 dB under at 25–50 Hz, where the camera's response is unknown). Third octaves agree within 1.2 dB from 200 Hz to 5 kHz; below that a band holds one or two harmonics, and which of them stand on the cabin's resonances is a draw, so they differ by up to 13 dB. The floor between the lines within 1.9 dB from 39 to 500 Hz but for one third octave. The proprotors make 93.4 dBA, the drive 97.4, the wind 78.8 and the engines 50.2, 98.9 dBA in all at the camera. That absolute figure is not a measurement: the drive's level is set from the recording relative to the proprotors, so it rests on them. Table 8 shows that each term earns its place: without the wing the harmonics from the 14th fall into the floor and those from the 6th lose half their height; with the rotors in step the low ones stand 4 dB over the recording's; and in sea-level air the surface layer's turbulence buries them. The trim wall changes the proprotors least; its work is on the wind, which this table holds fixed. Those statistics were matched with the parameters listed in Table 2, so the table shows how consistent the physics is with one recording, not that it predicts one.

**Table 9:** What this report's corrections changed.

| Measure | before | after | test |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bo 105 tip twist, $C_T/\sigma$ 0.12, deg | +3.3 | −1.4 | nose down |
| Bo 105 torsion at 0.34 $R$, in lb | −319 | −500 | −500 |
| Bo 105 collective, test less model, deg | 4.1–8.5 | 2.9–4.2 | (FDM 2.5–3.1) |
| HART II tip twist, mean, deg | −0.1 | −1.1 | about −1 |
| HART II BVI load, rms, ratio to test | 3.7 | 1.6 | 1 |
| HART II noise map, mean error, dB | +5.5 | +0.6 | 0 |
| XV-15 near field, 10 000 lb, dB | 133.1 | 124.9 | 128.4 |

## 5.11 The ASK 21

The computed stall speed at 540 kg is 34.7 kt, the flight manual's 35. In the cockpit the canopy's boundary layer dominates, 79 dBA at 50 kt and 86 at 120 kt. In aerobatics recorded from the front seat, airspeed read off the needle frame by frame, the shape from 315 Hz to 6.3 kHz is within 0.9–1.9 dB rms at 53 to 112 kt (Fig. 15a), and from 400 Hz to 8 kHz, without the bands a whistle of this glider's own crosses, the sound's power grows as the airspeed to the power 2.2, the model's 1.9; from 3 to 8 kHz it grows 38 dB a decade against 29. A second glider, 242 s free of the music's cymbals, keeps the shape within 2.5 dB from 400 Hz to 4 kHz. Both fall faster than the model above 5 kHz and have more below 250 Hz; how much of that their cameras make can't be told. In a barrelled roll with the load factor read off the g-meter, the band swings 8 dB against the model's 4, the same way, and in the pull-up grows 2.2 dB per $g$ against 0.2. Leaks through the canopy's seals, driven by the lift and the slip, would do this. So might the camera, and one recording can't tell them apart.

## 5.12 Cost

On an Apple M1 (8 cores), busy with other work during this run (a load average of 57.0, which about doubles these times), the source-time, closed-form kernel takes 41 ms where the classic retarded-time iteration, as the original WOPWOP does it, with the same compiler, takes 348 ms, 8 times as long for the same answer. A UH-60A descent's trim, elastic response and wake take 2.9 s, Formulation 1A at one listener 0.43 s (50 million source evaluations a second), and a whole 15 s loop from nothing 46 s. PSU-WOPWOP itself was not timed: its binary is distributed on request, so no ratio is claimed.

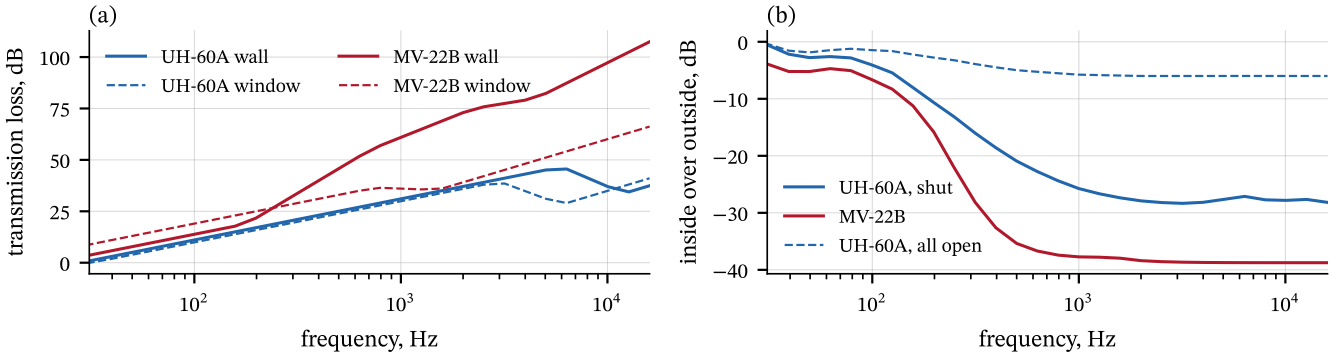



**Figure 13:** (a) Transmission loss of the walls and windows; (b) what reaches the listener of what is outside.

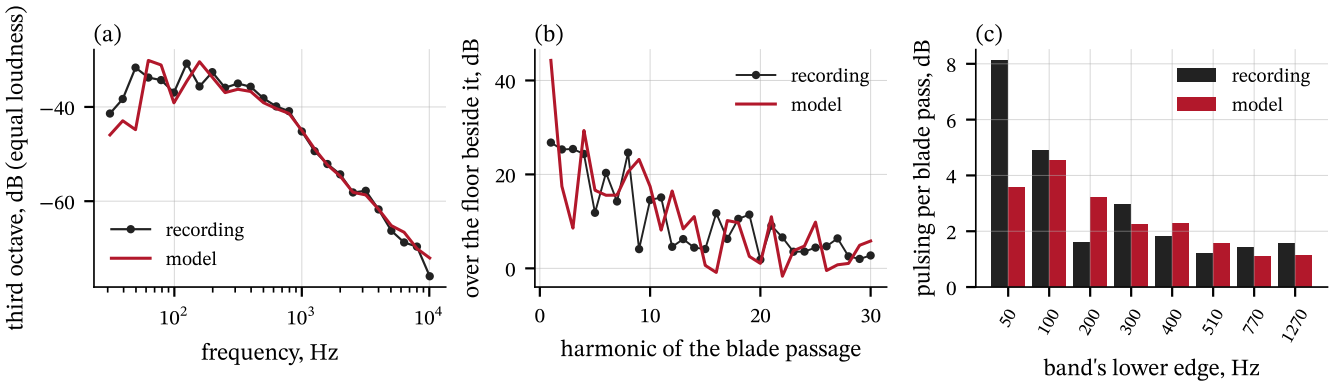



**Figure 14:** MV-22B in cruise behind the pilots, model against recording at equal loudness: (a) third octaves; (b) each blade harmonic over the broadband beside it; (c) how hard each band pulses with the blades.

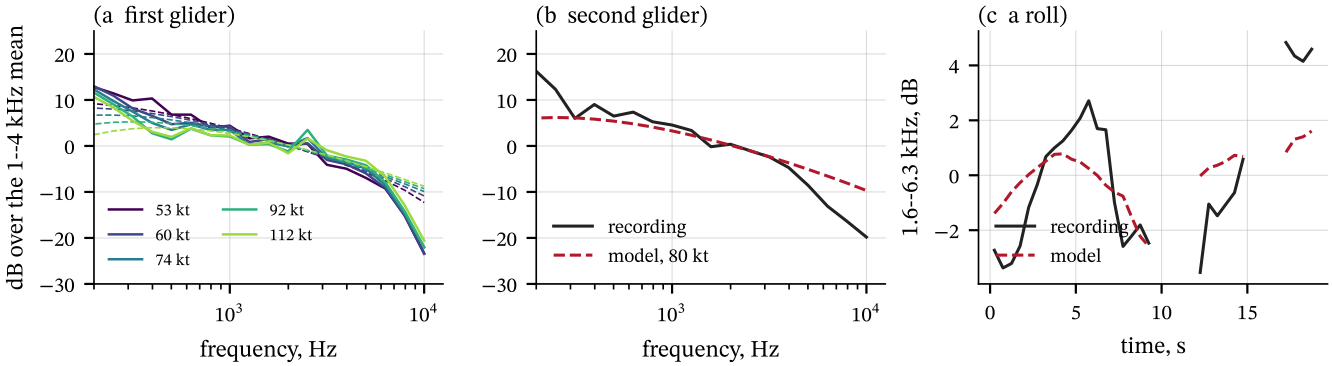



**Figure 15:** ASK 21 cockpits: (a) spectra by airspeed, solid the recording and dashed the model, each set to its 1–4 kHz mean; (b) a second glider; (c) a barrelled roll, the 1.6–6.3 kHz band, in the stretches where the ASI reads.

# 6 Corrections found during validation

The changes the comparisons forced are listed because each removed a physical, numerical or measuring error rather than tuning a coefficient. The first seven were found by this report's programme (Table 9).

1. *The blades' pitching moment.* The section's moment about the elastic axis was the dynamic pressure, which held one chord already, times the chord squared: one chord too many, in metres. So the Bo 105's aerodynamic moment was 27 % of its value and the centrifugal term won: the blade twisted nose-up with thrust by +3.3°, where NASA measured nose-down moments. Every elastic rotor had it, and every check passed, since the trim absorbs a twist in the collective. Comparing the moment with its three parts' sum found it, within 0.01°.
2. *The propeller moment* on the set pitch was missing from the torsion load.
3. *A trim that failed in silence.* After 80 iterations the trim returned whatever it had. The XV-15's generic smooth section stalled so abruptly that the rotor could not make $C_T/\sigma$ of 0.16, and what came back had 6.5 times the power, 133.1 and 107.7 dB at the stand's microphones where the test has 128.4 and 99.2. The Bo 105 at $\mu = 0.33$ had no such excuse: nearly converged, a stale Jacobian and the lagging elastic state threw the iteration out, and it marched to 90° of cyclic and 14 times the power (this with the moment of item 1 corrected; the old blade happened to converge there). The trim now falls back to its best point in smaller steps, and stops with an error if it can't reach its thrust. Of 43 conditions that had converged, none moved at all. The XV-15 has the V-22 model's 64-series table.
4. *The vortex core's target.* Section 5.5: it had been aimed at a mean taken for a swing, and on other rotors than HART II's.
5. *A door check that wasn't.* Closing a UH-60's cabin doors

in a recording was said to take 18.3 dB off the whine at 10 kHz, within a decibel of the walls' model. The figure came from one line in a ±15 Hz window. In fact the two engines' lines drift from 10.04 to 10.13 kHz through that moment at constant level (Fig. 11c): the band's power changes 1.2 dB, the window's 17.6. The check is withdrawn; nothing in the recording shows a door.

6. *The skin friction.* The wall pressure's 1/7-power law falls short past $Re_x = 10^7$. The Tu-144LL's flight spectra, whose shape the model had right, stood 4.8 dB over it; White's law takes half of that, and 1 to 2 dB more of wind on an MV-22B.
7. *The HART II map, read upside down* at first by this report's author, which correlated at 0.25 and was corrected from the paper's text (Section 2), not from that correlation.
8. *Perfect periodicity.* The first loops' passages correlated at 0.99 against the recordings' 0.2–0.6, with tones 12 to 17 dB too strong. Hence the revolutions of their own and the blade-wake noise.
9. *Sea-level air in a cruise at 10 000 ft* made every rotor pressure 2.6 dB too strong, and the near-ground turbulence an inflow rumble as strong as the harmonics.
10. *True for calibrated airspeed.* A simulator fades by calibrated airspeed, so a bank flying the same figure as true airspeed at altitude fell 4 dB short.
11. *The canopy's 30 dB leak cap*, assumed for a glider's seals, left the cockpit flat from 2 kHz up, 6 to 8 dB too bright. Recordings removed it.
12. *The rotors in step.* Below the cabin's lowest mode their pressures add coherently; in step the MV-22B's second harmonic stood 12 dB too strong.
13. *Beating.* With equal levels neighbouring harmonics beat, and a band pulsed 14 dB a blade pass where the recording's pulses 5. The cabin's modal response removed it.
14. *An A-weighted level match* made an A/B comparison sound nothing alike. Equal loudness by BS.1770 is what a listener compares.
15. *A coarse blade-passing frequency.* Fitting it from the first harmonic at 0.18 Hz resolution missed every line above the 12th; the recording's over-floor numbers had to be redone from the 6th to the 25th lines.
16. *The gearbox's fade* ended at the helicopter mode's rotor speed, taking 1.5 dB off in cruise at 83.7 %.

# 7 Assessment

Table 10 summarises. The core of the program, from a rotor's published data to the pressure at a microphone, is now tested in absolute decibels, and it holds: on a full-scale rotor with nothing fitted, near and far, and on the elastic blade's moments. Blade–vortex interaction needs one calibrated constant and then reproduces the level, the lobes and the trends of the one test that measured them all. These are the program's strongest results, and they are also its newest: none of them existed before this report, and two of the faults they found had been passing every check for days.

Its weakest results are those that sound the most convincing. The MV-22B's cockpit agrees with its recording because many of its parameters were measured from that recording, by a camera of unknown response in one flight condition. The one calibrated cockpit level shows the UH-60A's 3–6 dB low, and the MV-22B's hover cockpit is unverified against anything. The cabins' skins and absorption are estimates. The model's power at high speed runs short. Linear acoustics stop near Mach 0.9 at the advancing tip; the wake is prescribed, with no lag motion and uniform blades; there is no fuselage scattering and no main rotor wake on the tail rotor; the conversion between a tiltrotor's modes is a cross-fade. HART II's rotor is a Mach-scaled Bo 105, so the core's transfer to a UH-60A or a V-22 rotor rests on its being a property of the method more than of the rotor.

What would change this most is cheap to state: a calibrated cockpit spectrum of any of these aircraft, such as the UH-60A's octave bands in USAARL's report 2000-19, the FAA's flyovers of the UH-60A in FAA-EE-81-16, a recording of a door actually closing, and flight-test noise of a rotor in descent. The first two exist; their servers refused this programme's download, and they are left for its next issue.

**Table 10:** Summary: ✓ within the data's scatter, ~ partly, × not reproduced. (P) a prediction, (C) calibrated on it, (M) parameters measured from it.

| | |
|---|---|
| Solvers against closed forms and NASA's BPM code (P) | ✓ |
| XV-15 rotor hover power (section fitted) | ✓ |
| Bo 105 hover power (P) | ~ |
| Bo 105 forward-flight power (P) | ✓ |
| UH-60A level-flight power at high speed (P) | × |
| Bo 105 torsion moment (P) | ✓ |
| HART II tip twist (P) | ✓ |
| Bo 105 collective (P) | ~ |
| XV-15 near-field level against thrust (P) | ✓ |
| XV-15 far-field level against thrust (P) | ✓ |
| HART II noise: mean (C) | ✓ |
| HART II noise: lobes and map (P) | ~ |
| HART II load above 10/rev (C) | ~ |
| Pass-to-pass texture (assumed unsteadiness) | ✓ |
| XV-15 fountain: behind and ahead (P) | ✓ |
| XV-15 fountain spikes at shallow angles (P) | ~ |
| Wall pressure in flight: shape (P) | ✓ |
| Wall pressure in flight: level (P) | ~ |
| MV-22 hover table (P, geometry unknown) | ~ |
| MV-22 airplane mode below (P) | ✓ |
| T700 cycle (P) | ✓ |
| Turbine tones' frequencies (M) | ✓ |
| Gearbox tone against torque (P) | × |
| UH-60A cockpit level (gearbox from a review) | ~ |
| Cabin doors | not tested |
| Whine chopped by the proprotor | not modelled |
| MV-22B cockpit shape and statistics (M) | ✓ |
| ASK 21 cockpit shape, 315 Hz–6.3 kHz (P) | ✓ |
| ASK 21 above 5 kHz and below 250 Hz (P) | × |
| ASK 21 hiss against load factor (P) | × |

# 8 Conclusions

- One program takes a rotor's published geometry to seamless, alias-free loops for a flight simulator: trim, elastic blades, a prescribed wake, Formulation 1A, BPM and Amiet, cabin paths, engines from their cycles, a glider's airframe, and a FlightGear section.

- Its solvers agree with closed forms and NASA's code to the tables' precision.
- With nothing fitted, a full-scale XV-15 rotor's overall level is reproduced within 2.6 dB rms over its whole thrust range 2 ft from its tip path, the dip where the twisted blade's tip unloads included, and within 2.2 dB at 76 m; a Bo 105 blade's torsion moment within 12 %.
- With one effective vortex core calibrated on HART II's noise, that test's map has a scatter of 5.0 dB with both of its lobes, its maximum near the shaft angle the test found.
- A tiltrotor's fountain gives the noise behind the aircraft that NASA found in 1981, in kind and in its added level.
- Recordings of unknown gain give frequencies and shapes reliably and levels not at all; used so, they gave the T700's blade counts, the MV-22B's drive and the ASK 21's canopy.
- The programme behind this report found one dimensional error, one missing term, one solver that failed in silence, one calibration aimed at the wrong quantity and one check that had measured nothing. They had all passed the tests that existed. Primary data did what tests of a program against itself cannot.

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